



DECLUTTER-BY-AREA PLAYBOOK

(All work is done in 30- to 60-minute blocks. The **staging zone** changes depending on which room you are working on, and **the sell-rack can stay in the current staging zone** – NK-room or Loft



DEFINITIONS

Term	Meaning
Staging zone	A single, temporary holding spot depending on the room you are currently decluttering (upstairs staging area -> NK room or loft; downstairs staging area -> outside bins, garage for large items, loft for small items if needed). All items you have already sorted but that don't yet have a permanent home stay inside that zone .
Essentials	Everyday-use items you need while you're decluttering that room. • NK-room → weekly-clothes tote • Guest-room → shoe bin • Loft → usually none
Permanent location	The final place where an item belongs (another closet, a shelf, the garage rack, etc.). If the spot is ready, put the item there immediately; otherwise leave it in the staging zone and label the bin with the intended destination (e.g., "→ Guest-room closet").
Outside bins	When the only permanent home is the garage , the item stays in a labeled bin placed on a wheeled rack outside the back door until the garage is ready.
Donate box	Must be a large moving-box-size container . Seal it immediately and set it by the door or in the car for donation run.
Sell rack	A portable rack that can stay in the current staging zone (NK-room or Loft). Clothing you intend to sell goes on this rack; larger sell items that won't fit in a bin stay in the garage, clearly labeled "SELL – [item] – Pending".

COLOUR-CODE LEGEND

Colour	Meaning	Where the bin lives
 Green	Keep – will end up in a permanent location.	Starts in the staging zone for the current room (or on the outside rack if the final home is the garage).
 Blue	Donate – must be placed immediately into a large box (moving-box size).	Box is sealed right away and set by the door or in the car for the next morning's run.
 Yellow	Sell – items you will list online.	Clothing → sell-rack (kept in the current staging zone). Large non-clothing sell items → stay in the garage , clearly labeled “SELL – ...”.
 Red	Trash / recycle – immediate disposal.	Throw away right away; no bin needed after the session.

MASTER CHECKLIST

Declutter-By-Area Quick-Start (30-60 min blocks)

NK-Room (staging zone)

- ☐ Essentials tote – weekly clothes (label “DO NOT MOVE”)
- ☐ Pull & sort each item as you remove it:
 -  Keep → green bin on floor (label destination if not ready)
 -  Donate → large box, seal now, set by door or in car
 -  Sell (clothing) → place on NK-room sell-rack
 -  Sell (large) → leave in garage, label “SELL – Pending”
 -  Trash → discard
- ☐ If Keep item has a ready spot, place it there now
- ☐ Sweep/vacuum, close closet
- ☐ Seal donation box (date on side, keep by door/car)

Guest-Room Closet

- ☐ Essentials shoe bin (label “DO NOT MOVE”)
- ☐ Pull & sort each item (same 4-step decision)
- ☐ Keep → green bin on floor (label destination) or place directly
- ☐ Sell (clothing) → place on Guest-room sell-rack (optional)
- ☐ Sweep/vacuum, close closet
- ☐ Trash
- ☐ Transfer donation box/es to door or car
- ☐ Transfer green bins to NK-staging zone

Upstairs Main Closet

- ☐ Pull & sort each item (same 4-step decision)
- ☐ Keep → green bin on floor (label destination) or place directly
- ☐ Sell → place on upstairs sell-rack (optional)
- ☐ Sweep/vacuum, close closet
- ☐ Trash
- ☐ Transfer donation box/es to door or car
- ☐ Transfer green bins to NK-staging zone

Loft (fourth staging zone)

- ☐ Decide staging location (NK-room floor or loft floor)
- ☐ Pull & sort each item (same 4-step decision)
- ☐ Keep → green bin on chosen floor (label destination) or place directly
- ☐ Sell (clothing) → place on loft sell-rack (you can use the same portable rack)
- ☐ Sweep/vacuum loft
- ☐ Trash
- ☐ Transfer donation box/es to door or car
- ☐ Transfer green bins to NK-room staging zone (if loft used)

Garage

- ☐ Set up wheeled rack by the back door (outside rack)
- ☐ Pull & sort items brought out (same 4-step decision)
 -  Keep → labeled green bin **on the outside rack** (write final garage rack #)
 -  Donate → large box, seal now, set by door or in car
 -  Sell clothing → place on sell-rack upstairs

- ● Large sell → leave in garage, label “SELL – Pending”
- ● Trash → discard

☐ Move outside racks inside when there is space